HACK876 × N.C.B. FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Jamaica's next digital producers have to start somewhere.

The NCB Foundation pays for students to sit IT exams so Jamaica can grow its pool of digital producers. Hack876 gives them one day to actually produce something.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers

WHY THE NCB FOUNDATION

The N.C.B. Foundation pays for students to sit CSEC IT so that Jamaica can grow its pool of digital producers.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Platinum contribution toward the inaugural event, or any level that suits the Foundation this year.

Platinum Partner: J$1,000,000+. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support the prizes, student meals and the running of the day.

WHAT THE NCB FOUNDATION RECEIVES

About 80 secondary-school students spend a day turning IT skills into a working prototype. The Foundation receives Platinum recognition and a written recap.

THE NEXT STEP

A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, and which route it prefers: a direct grant, or NCB's sponsorship request form. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min



01 WHY THE NCB FOUNDATION

You already invest in the subjects. We add the first build.

Hack876 is where students who sit IT get to prove they can build with it.

N.C.B. FOUNDATION MISSION

"Empowering minds, strengthening communities and building Jamaica's future."[1]

The Foundation is the philanthropic arm of the NCB Financial Group, funded by 1% of NCB Jamaica's annual profits.[1]

In 2019 it shifted its focus to digital, with a goal to support the expansion of the pool of digital producers in Jamaica.[2]

Its 2026 CSEC bursary covers Information Technology, Principles of Accounts and Principles of Business, built around access, relevance and preparedness.[3]

THE RECORD

SINCE 2003

1% of profits, every year.

Funded by 1% of NCB Jamaica's annual profits, with J$1BN+ invested in education and 111,720 students assisted (as at December 2024).[1]

2019

A deliberate turn to digital.

The Foundation shifted its focus to digital to grow Jamaica's pool of digital producers, moving its CSEC bursary towards Information Technology.[2]

2026

3,183 students. 36 schools.

J$15.9 million in CSEC exam fees for IT, Principles of Accounts and Principles of Business, up from 1,310 students in 2025.[3]

SCHOLARSHIPS

Tech comes first.

Undergraduate scholarships give preference to computing, software, data science, cybersecurity and creative technologies.[4]

02 OUR REQUEST

Become a Platinum Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$1,000,000+ PLATINUM PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Platinum is flexible: it helps support prizes, meals and the day itself in one gift. If a smaller gift fits the Foundation better this year, a contribution at any level is welcome.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- ✓ **The event overall.** Used where it helps the students most.
- ✓ **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- ✓ **Student meals.** Contributes toward meals and refreshments on the day.
- ✓ **Event production.** Helps support staging, sound and the room.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

A detailed event budget will follow before any formal commitment is asked for.

WHAT THE NCB FOUNDATION WOULD RECEIVE

- ✓ **Everything in Gold**
- ✓ **The most prominent placement on the website and event signage**
- ✓ **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner SUGGESTED
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

A first-year event, with the essentials in place.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.
THE DAY	One day, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM: an opening, a build period with mentors, judging, finals and awards.

SCHOOL NETWORK AND STATUS

Hillel Academy	CONFIRMED
Campion College	CONFIRMED
Jamaica College	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Immaculate Conception High School	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Wolmer's	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Ardenne High School	IN TALKS
American International School of Kingston	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. Andrew High School for Girls	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. George's College	NOT YET CONFIRMED

2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed. This is the network where the Hack876 team has relationships. It is not a list of confirmed participants, and it is not an exclusive eligibility list.

The Foundation's Chair, Thalia Lyn, is an Immaculate alumna and the school's first Hall of Fame inductee, and has backed a technology scholarship there. Our judge Sheneska Williams is an Immaculate alumna too.[6] Status with Hack876: not yet confirmed.

SAFEGUARDS. MANY PARTICIPANTS ARE MINORS.

Partners and donors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day.

Mentors and volunteers work in open, supervised spaces.

Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

The judging panel decides every award. Funding carries no influence over judging and no naming rights.

What you would see afterwards, and what we need from you now.

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ How many students, teams and schools took part
- ✓ What the teams built, with the finalist projects described
- ✓ How your contribution was used
- ✓ Photos, only where schools and parents have consented

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

POSSIBLE LATER, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

Places for students from CSEC IT bursary schools as Hack876 grows.

A clear signpost from Hack876 to the Foundation's Digital and National Scholarships.

A link to the Level Up Grants Programme for students who want to keep building.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, and which route it prefers: a direct grant, or NCB's sponsorship request form. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

NCB's sponsorship form asks how an initiative aligns with Empowering People, Unlocking Dreams, Building Communities, and how success will be measured. We have answered both here.[7]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

We would love to explore the right first step with Perrin, Thalia and the N.C.B. Foundation team.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No banking products, accounts or financial offers are marketed to students. Many participants are minors.

No student data is collected or shared for the Foundation or NCB. Any recap uses group numbers and school-approved photos only.

Volunteers and judges work in open, supervised spaces.

05 APPENDIX

Contribution levels, and what each receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

1. National Commercial Bank Jamaica, "N.C.B. Foundation: Who We Are." www.jncb.com/about-us/ncb-foundation/who-we-are/

2. Jamaica Observer, "NCB Foundation expands CSEC bursary (March 22, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/03/22/ncb-foundation-expands-csec-bursary

3. Jamaica Information Service, "NCB Foundation Provides $15.9 Million to Pay Exam Fees for 3,183 Students (April 18, 2026)." jis.gov.jm/ncb-foundation-provides-15-9-million-to-pay-exam-fees-for-3183-students/

4. Jamaica Observer, "'Don't count yourself out' (July 8, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/07/08/dont-count-yourself-out/

5. National Commercial Bank Jamaica, "N.C.B. Foundation: Explore Opportunities." www.jncb.com/about-us/ncb-foundation/opportunities/

6. Jamaica Observer, "Lyn announces technology scholarship at Immaculate High (March 24, 2024)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2024/03/24/lyn-announces-technology-scholarship-immaculate-high/

7. National Commercial Bank Jamaica, "NCB Sponsorships." www.jncb.com/about-us/sponsorships/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Perrin Gayle, Chief Executive Officer, N.C.B. Foundation. Attention: Thalia Lyn, Chair.